

3.1 Common Pitfalls: Why Labels and Freeform Bios Fail

Before you begin the excavation, understand why your previous profiling attempts produced generic output. Each failure mode below points to the same root cause: surface descriptions leave the AI's default linguistic architecture untouched.

Approach	What You Did	Why It Failed	What the AI Actually Received
Freeform character bios	Wrote paragraphs of backstory and personality description	The AI reads bios as background context, then generates using its default speech patterns	A vague mood; no structural instructions for sentence length, vocabulary, or rhythm
Personality-type labels	Typed "introvert," "sardonic," "sunshine"	Labels are categorical; the AI fills each category with its generic template	The same output it would produce for any character tagged with that label
Vague behavioral notes	Wrote "He speaks in short sentences. He has trust issues."	Descriptions float on top of the AI's defaults without restructuring them	A thin coat of paint over the same polite-verbose foundation

The Fix: Replace every label and bio with the seven-layer excavation below. Each layer produces specific, measurable data about how the character's psychology shapes their speech. The AI receives architectural instructions rather than mood descriptions.